

**Undo Levels**

The Undo tool is useful to fix any errors that may have occurred while working in Flash. Undo does take some amount of system resources by keeping track of all of the steps on the way. Fortunately, you can set the limit on how many undos one can execute. Go to **Edit > Preferences**. Change the values for the number of levels allowed and click OK.

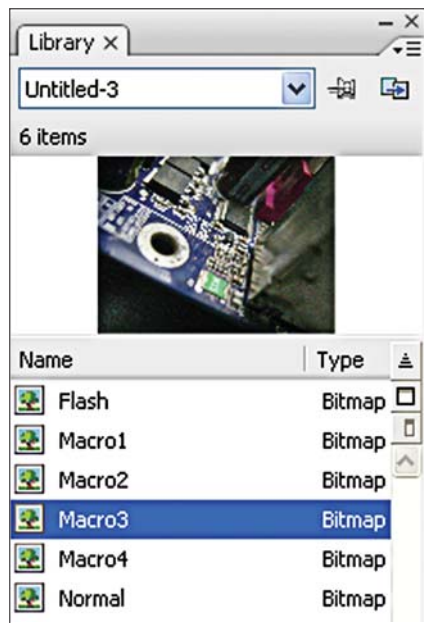
**Using Custom Workspaces**

Every individual has his or her own way of working and arranging tools. Every kind of workspace layout is suitable for a particular kind of work. Use the workspace tool to save any workspace layout that you've made. Click on **Window > Workspace > Save current** to save a workspace. To access the workspace at any time, click on **Window > Workspace** and then select your custom workspace.

**Importing Files In Library**

Importing images and other media into the library in Flash is a good practice. It's easier to manage and access files rather than directly importing single files into the stage. Click on **File > Import > Import to library**. Now you can simply drag and drop elements to your project and at the same time you get a small preview of the same.

Flash CS3 can also directly open up Flash projects on sites instead of downloading the files on your local machine first and then opening them. Click on **File > Open from Site**.



The library is one click access to all the required resources

Choose the site on which you have the project hosted. Enter the password. Sites can be added by clicking on **File > Edit Sites**.

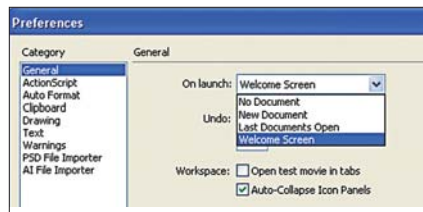
Flash is the latest in the Adobe family of products. Integration between all the products has been built into it as well. When you try and import a Photoshop file (PSD), for example, you will be displayed all the layers in the file and you get to choose which ones you want to import. You can import each of the layers as separate keyframes or layers.

**Exporting Animations To Movies**

Flash isn't used for just Web content. Flash is actually used by a lot of other media like in TV advertising. Keeping that in mind, the developers of Flash have allowed the user to export animations as standard video formats. When your animation is ready, click on **File > Export > Export Movie**. Choose the format and enter a filename and location. Click **Save**. Depending on the format, you will be asked to set compression settings and the codecs to be used.

**Disabling The Launch Screen**

The Welcome or Launch screen is the one that pops up as soon as you start Flash CS3. It's useful in loading up different kinds of projects and templates for platforms such as mobile devices. Instead of having to select your recently saved project every single time, you can have your last open file load up by itself. Go to **Edit > Preferences**. Click on the **On launch** dropdown



The annoying Launch screen can be disabled if required

menu and choose **Last Documents Open**. If you want no files open, choose **No Document**. Click OK to save.

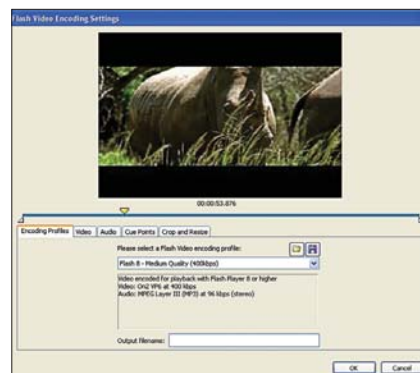
**Using Images Instead Of Colour As Fill**

Instead of having plain colours for objects, you can make use of images instead. Click on the **Color** window to the right, choose the **Color** tab. Click the **Type** dropdown and choose **Bitmap**. Click the **Import** button and select the image you want to use. Now use any of the painting tools—**Brush** or the **Paint Bucket Tool** to color

objects and the image will be applied in place of color. You can also use this feature to have images as fill colors while creating new objects as well.

**Video Encoding In Flash CS3**

Adobe Flash CS3 comes along with a video encoding utility which is useful in converting videos from almost every format into Flash. Click on **Adobe Flash CS3 Video Encoder** from the **Start Menu** to start it. Click on **Add** to add the videos for conversion. Click on



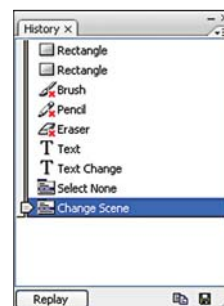
Flash CS3 comes with a standalone video encoder

the **Settings** button to set parameters for the conversion. You can quickly choose from one of the readymade presets available by selecting one from the dropdown menu. Use the sliders to set the region you want to encode and set video and audio compression settings using the **Video** and **Audio** tabs. Click OK when done. Click **Start Queue** to start the conversion process.

If you are planning to use a video in the Flash project, you can also import a video into Flash CS3 itself by clicking on **File > Import > Import Video**. Here you are asked to enter the location of the file and where it would eventually be deployed—web server, Flash Media Server, etc. Clicking **Next** shows up a window similar to that of the Flash CS3 Video Encoder after which you're asked to select the template for the player.

**Using The History Window**

The History feature, like in Photoshop, keeps track of all the actions you've executed in Flash. At anytime you wish, you can jump back to any step by clicking on that



The history window gives a list of steps